

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

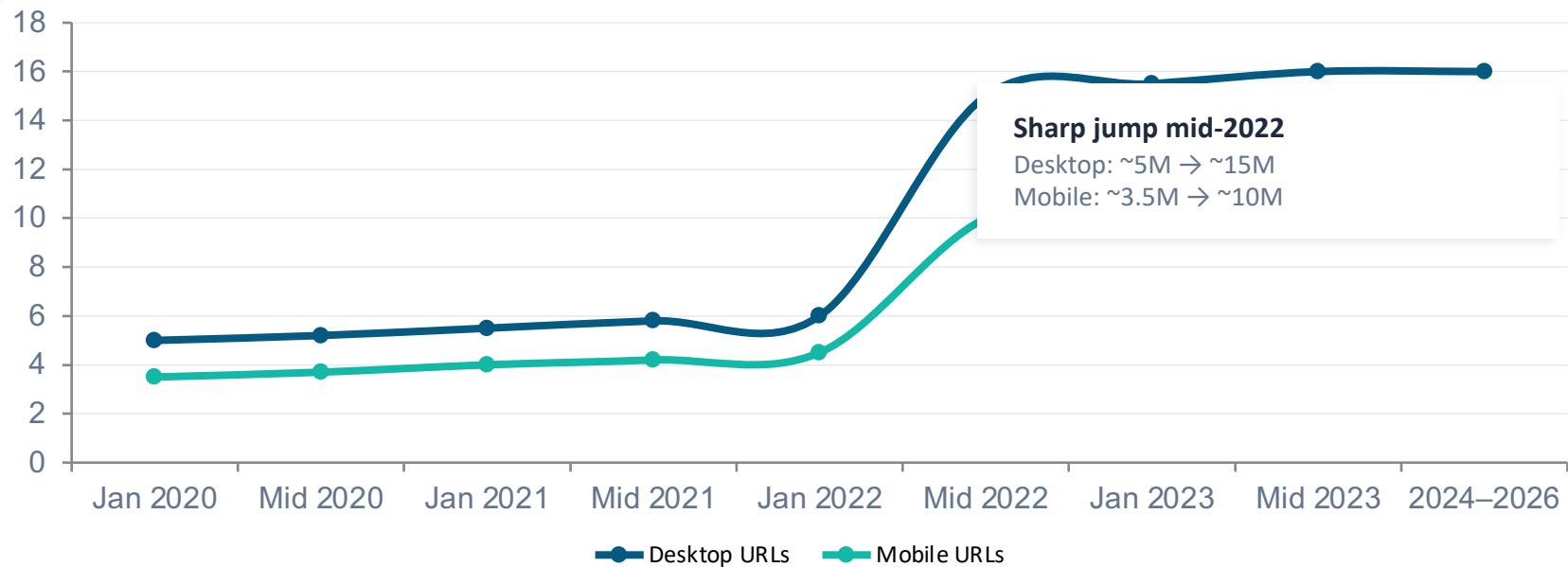
Data Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Time Range: January 2020 – March 2026

Audience: Web Performance Engineers & Front-End Architects

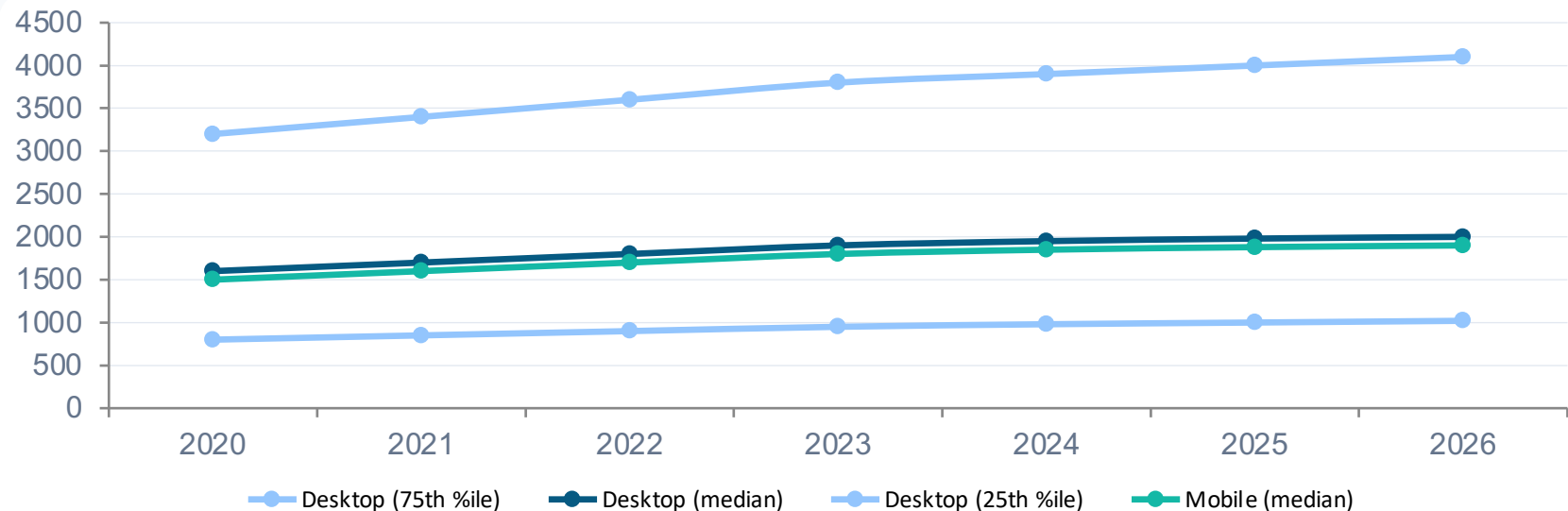
Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily

~2,000 KB on Desktop; Mobile Tracks Slightly Below



▲ ~25%

Desktop growth since 2020

▲ ~25%

Mobile growth since 2020

> 4,000 KB

75th-percentile desktop

Requests Rise ~3% While TCP Connections Drop

Multiplexing gains from HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 improve connection efficiency

76

Desktop requests (median)

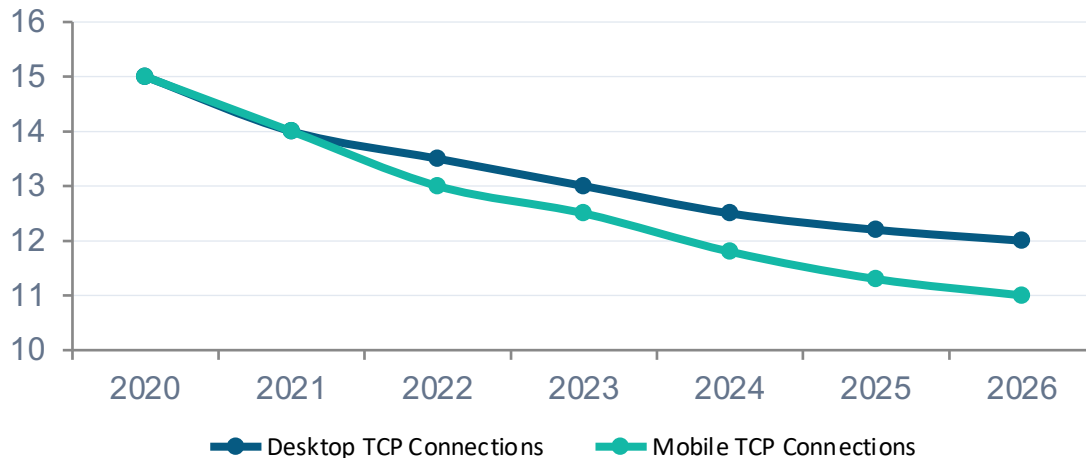
▲ 2.7%

71

Mobile requests (median)

▲ 2.9%

TCP Connections per Page (Median)



▼ 14.3% desktop | ▼ 26.7% mobile — fewer connections despite more requests

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%

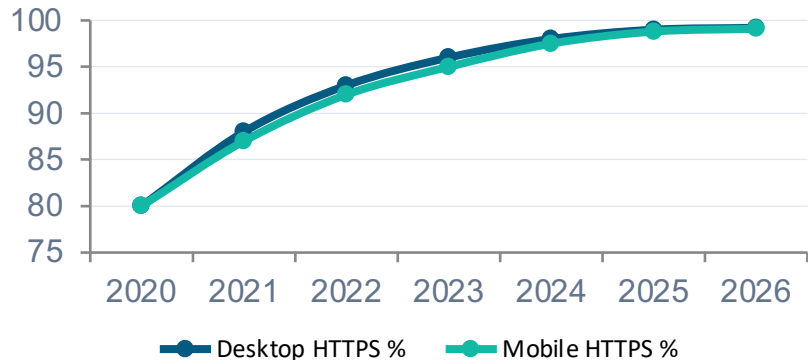
Encryption Is Now the Default on the Modern Web

99%+

of requests now use HTTPS

Desktop: 99.2% | Mobile: 99.1%

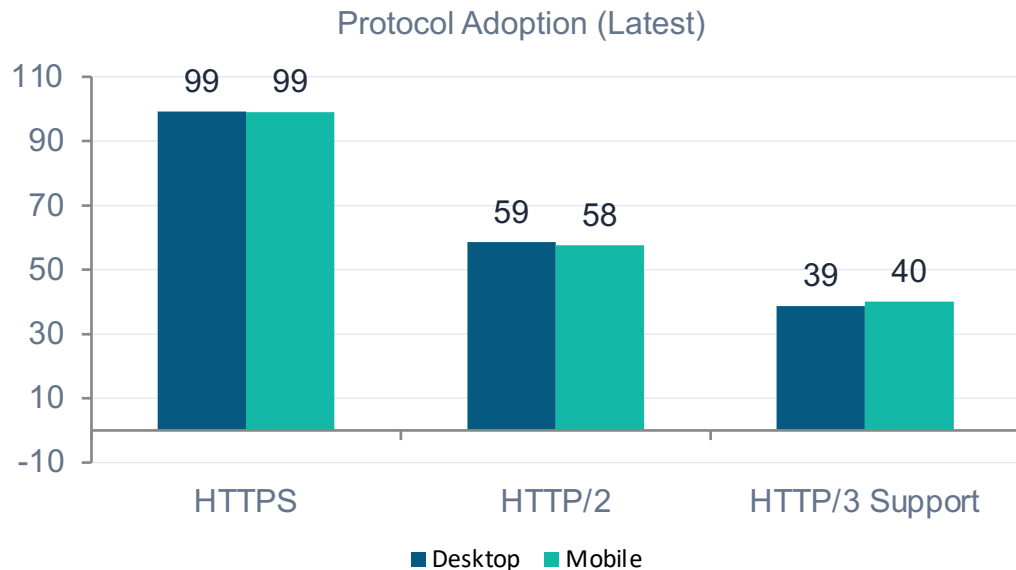
HTTPS Adoption Trajectory



▲ ~19–20 percentage points since early 2020 — unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Surges to ~40%

Protocol adoption snapshot: HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing metric



HTTP/3 Growth

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years

▲ 38,600% desktop | ▲ 5,614% mobile

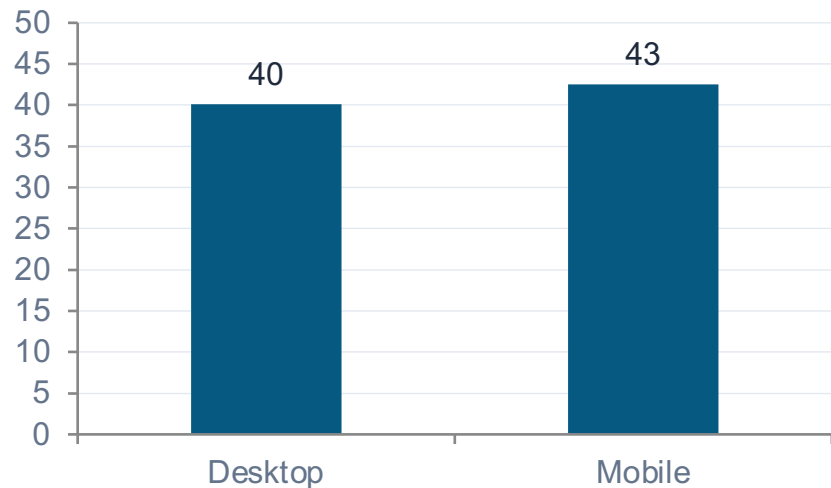
Measurement Caveat

HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage. Fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 capability via Alt-Svc headers.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile

Up 61% since 2020 — yet more than half of pages still risk FOIT

Current Adoption (2025–2026)



Growth Since 2020

Desktop: up 14.9%

Mobile: up 61.0%

Why It Matters

The font-display CSS property avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during web font loading. At ~40–42% adoption, significant room for improvement remains.

Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

Call to Action: Benchmark your own sites against these baselines and prioritize optimization efforts.